

Supplementary Information for: Predicted Gene-Program Activations from Histology Are Fragile to Routine Image Perturbations, and the Failure Mode Depends on the Encoder

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This file contains supplementary tables referenced in the main text. All numbers here are produced by the same pipeline and scripts described in the main text’s Methods section and cited from the same repository (see Code Availability).

Table S4: CONCH: linear-offset correction’s relative GPFR reduction (main text Section 2.7), summarized per perturbation across its 5 programs. Positive = correction lowered GPFR; negative = made it worse. `jpeg`’s min (-133%) is the largest actual worsening observed – the correction is not a reliably-signed effect even within one perturbation, let alone across the suite.

Perturbation	Mean reduction	Min	Max
brightness	34%	14%	62%
contrast	37%	12%	53%
gamma	23%	-33%	68%
stain_shift	8%	-22%	43%
blur	7%	-29%	47%
jpeg	-14%	-133%	56%
scanner_color	31%	5%	65%

Table S1: CONCH: Gene-Program Flip Rate (GPFR) per perturbation/program on IDC, with 95% CI from the 4-slide cluster bootstrap (2000 resamples) and Benjamini-Hochberg FDR-corrected q -value across all 35 tests. * FDR<0.05 AND the CI's lower bound does not round to 0.000 – with only 4 slides to resample, the one-sided bootstrap p -value is quantized (at most $4^4 = 256$ distinct resample outcomes, giving as few as 6–9 distinct p -values across all 35 tests here), so it can reject the boundary null for an interval that still visibly touches zero; requiring both keeps the star consistent with the printed interval.

Perturbation	Program	GPFR	95% CI	FDR q
scanner_color	hypoxia	0.399	[0.329, 0.593]	0.0006*
brightness	hypoxia	0.191	[0.111, 0.314]	0.0006*
scanner_color	immune_activation	0.191	[0.041, 0.501]	0.0006*
jpeg	hypoxia	0.187	[0.100, 0.391]	0.0006*
contrast	hypoxia	0.152	[0.065, 0.248]	0.0006*
stain_shift	hypoxia	0.134	[0.048, 0.275]	0.0006*
scanner_color	angiogenesis	0.132	[0.065, 0.220]	0.0006*
contrast	angiogenesis	0.124	[0.056, 0.202]	0.0006*
jpeg	stromal_ecm	0.120	[0.076, 0.193]	0.0006*
blur	angiogenesis	0.118	[0.080, 0.202]	0.0006*
blur	hypoxia	0.113	[0.073, 0.184]	0.0006*
stain_shift	proliferation	0.098	[0.076, 0.148]	0.0006*
blur	proliferation	0.091	[0.059, 0.147]	0.0006*
gamma	angiogenesis	0.088	[0.047, 0.138]	0.0006*
scanner_color	stromal_ecm	0.082	[0.067, 0.112]	0.0006*
scanner_color	proliferation	0.081	[0.049, 0.152]	0.0006*
jpeg	angiogenesis	0.073	[0.040, 0.124]	0.0006*
jpeg	proliferation	0.072	[0.049, 0.118]	0.0006*
brightness	angiogenesis	0.072	[0.029, 0.125]	0.0006*
stain_shift	angiogenesis	0.060	[0.029, 0.112]	0.0006*
gamma	hypoxia	0.056	[0.014, 0.145]	0.0006*
brightness	proliferation	0.047	[0.020, 0.099]	0.0006*
stain_shift	stromal_ecm	0.036	[0.020, 0.052]	0.0006*
blur	stromal_ecm	0.031	[0.012, 0.057]	0.0006*
brightness	stromal_ecm	0.030	[0.013, 0.054]	0.0034*
brightness	immune_activation	0.029	[0.002, 0.128]	0.0077*
contrast	proliferation	0.028	[0.011, 0.056]	0.0006*
contrast	stromal_ecm	0.024	[0.019, 0.032]	0.0006*
gamma	proliferation	0.019	[0.004, 0.040]	0.0044*
contrast	immune_activation	0.017	[0.012, 0.043]	0.0006*
gamma	stromal_ecm	0.016	[0.008, 0.024]	0.0006*
blur	immune_activation	0.013	[0.006, 0.066]	0.0053*
jpeg	immune_activation	0.010	[0.008, 0.060]	0.0006*
stain_shift	immune_activation	0.009	[0.002, 0.029]	0.0006*
gamma	immune_activation	0.003	[0.000, 0.007]	0.0655

Table S2: UNI: Gene-Program Flip Rate (GPFR) per perturbation/program on IDC, with 95% CI from the 4-slide cluster bootstrap (2000 resamples) and Benjamini-Hochberg FDR-corrected q -value across all 35 tests. * FDR<0.05 AND the CI's lower bound does not round to 0.000 – with only 4 slides to resample, the one-sided bootstrap p -value is quantized (at most $4^4 = 256$ distinct resample outcomes, giving as few as 6–9 distinct p -values across all 35 tests here), so it can reject the boundary null for an interval that still visibly touches zero; requiring both keeps the star consistent with the printed interval.

Perturbation	Program	GPFR	95% CI	FDR q
jpeg	immune_activation	0.264	[0.093, 0.640]	0.0006*
scanner_color	hypoxia	0.179	[0.120, 0.374]	0.0006*
scanner_color	immune_activation	0.162	[0.015, 0.506]	0.0006*
jpeg	hypoxia	0.154	[0.125, 0.236]	0.0006*
jpeg	proliferation	0.117	[0.040, 0.266]	0.0006*
stain_shift	proliferation	0.102	[0.028, 0.226]	0.0006*
stain_shift	hypoxia	0.098	[0.041, 0.187]	0.0006*
gamma	hypoxia	0.077	[0.032, 0.146]	0.0006*
contrast	angiogenesis	0.070	[0.034, 0.119]	0.0006*
stain_shift	angiogenesis	0.069	[0.020, 0.122]	0.0006*
jpeg	angiogenesis	0.069	[0.057, 0.093]	0.0006*
stain_shift	stromal_ecm	0.063	[0.027, 0.105]	0.0006*
scanner_color	angiogenesis	0.059	[0.038, 0.101]	0.0006*
gamma	angiogenesis	0.057	[0.021, 0.129]	0.0006*
jpeg	stromal_ecm	0.050	[0.019, 0.065]	0.0006*
scanner_color	proliferation	0.049	[0.026, 0.139]	0.0006*
brightness	angiogenesis	0.049	[0.041, 0.059]	0.0006*
scanner_color	stromal_ecm	0.040	[0.026, 0.053]	0.0006*
gamma	immune_activation	0.031	[0.009, 0.166]	0.0006*
brightness	hypoxia	0.031	[0.018, 0.055]	0.0006*
gamma	stromal_ecm	0.028	[0.019, 0.036]	0.0006*
contrast	immune_activation	0.028	[0.013, 0.114]	0.0006*
contrast	hypoxia	0.026	[0.002, 0.083]	0.0006*
blur	proliferation	0.022	[0.000, 0.052]	0.0413
contrast	stromal_ecm	0.020	[0.008, 0.044]	0.0006*
brightness	proliferation	0.017	[0.011, 0.040]	0.0006*
gamma	proliferation	0.017	[0.001, 0.056]	0.0048*
blur	angiogenesis	0.016	[0.003, 0.024]	0.0006*
blur	hypoxia	0.012	[0.003, 0.053]	0.0006*
contrast	proliferation	0.010	[0.002, 0.042]	0.0070*
brightness	stromal_ecm	0.009	[0.006, 0.020]	0.0037*
stain_shift	immune_activation	0.007	[0.000, 0.028]	0.2006
blur	stromal_ecm	0.002	[0.000, 0.003]	0.0413
brightness	immune_activation	0.002	[0.001, 0.030]	0.0237*
blur	immune_activation	0.000	[0.000, 0.000]	1.0000

Table S3: Spearman rank correlation of each z_{thresh} ’s GPFR ranking (across all 35 perturbation×program combinations) against the default $z_{\text{thresh}} = 1.0$ ranking, for both encoders on IDC.

z_{thresh}	CONCH ρ	UNI ρ
0.5	0.944	0.948
0.75	0.984	0.980
1.0	1.000	1.000
1.5	0.958	0.906
2.0	0.751	0.727

Table S5: Hallmark gene-set coverage on IDC’s 280-gene common panel – the intersection across all 4 IDC samples’ individual panels (288/321/280/280 genes for NCBI783/NCBI785/TENX95/TENX99 respectively; not identical across samples), i.e. exactly the gene set the modeling pipeline scores against. “Shared” counts genes that also belong to at least one other of the 5 scored programs. At this coverage, **proliferation** and **angiogenesis** are effectively small marker panels rather than comprehensive pathway scores.

Program	Genes present / total	Coverage	Shared with other programs
immune_activation	16/363	4.4%	1/16
proliferation	6/327	1.8%	0/6
hypoxia	8/200	4.0%	4/8
stromal_ecm	19/200	9.5%	3/19
angiogenesis	5/36	13.9%	4/5

Table S6: Stain-shift magnitude sweep on IDC (CONCH), including the **stain_shift_identity** null control (a full Macenko decompose/reconstruct round trip with NO intended stain-vector change). Any nonzero GPFR at Identity is reconstruction noise, not a real color-shift effect; the gap between Identity and Moderate is the actual effect size.

Magnitude	Mean SSIM	Mean GPFR	Max GPFR
Identity (null control)	0.981	0.036	0.081
Mild (h=1.10/e=0.90)	0.978	0.041	0.092
Moderate (h=1.30/e=0.70)	0.954	0.067	0.134

Table S7: CONCH: Gene-Program Flip Rate (GPFR) per perturbation/program on COAD, with 95% CI from the 4-slide cluster bootstrap (2000 resamples) and Benjamini-Hochberg FDR-corrected q -value across all 35 tests. * FDR<0.05 AND the CI's lower bound does not round to 0.000 – with only 4 slides to resample, the one-sided bootstrap p -value is quantized (at most $4^4 = 256$ distinct resample outcomes, giving as few as 6–9 distinct p -values across all 35 tests here), so it can reject the boundary null for an interval that still visibly touches zero; requiring both keeps the star consistent with the printed interval.

Perturbation	Program	GPFR	95% CI	FDR q
scanner_color	hypoxia	0.634	[0.553, 0.745]	0.0005*
jpeg	hypoxia	0.319	[0.257, 0.425]	0.0005*
blur	immune_activation	0.269	[0.204, 0.347]	0.0005*
brightness	hypoxia	0.228	[0.192, 0.282]	0.0005*
brightness	proliferation	0.201	[0.089, 0.374]	0.0005*
scanner_color	proliferation	0.178	[0.145, 0.272]	0.0005*
blur	hypoxia	0.174	[0.159, 0.215]	0.0005*
scanner_color	angiogenesis	0.162	[0.103, 0.250]	0.0005*
brightness	stromal_ecm	0.160	[0.122, 0.215]	0.0005*
scanner_color	immune_activation	0.142	[0.085, 0.222]	0.0005*
scanner_color	stromal_ecm	0.141	[0.057, 0.280]	0.0005*
blur	stromal_ecm	0.132	[0.062, 0.226]	0.0005*
blur	angiogenesis	0.130	[0.053, 0.221]	0.0005*
brightness	angiogenesis	0.129	[0.104, 0.161]	0.0005*
contrast	hypoxia	0.126	[0.066, 0.219]	0.0005*
stain_shift	hypoxia	0.121	[0.072, 0.195]	0.0005*
jpeg	immune_activation	0.112	[0.075, 0.146]	0.0005*
contrast	proliferation	0.090	[0.032, 0.215]	0.0005*
stain_shift	angiogenesis	0.082	[0.047, 0.114]	0.0005*
jpeg	angiogenesis	0.078	[0.052, 0.120]	0.0005*
blur	proliferation	0.077	[0.065, 0.134]	0.0005*
brightness	immune_activation	0.073	[0.027, 0.131]	0.0005*
jpeg	stromal_ecm	0.069	[0.041, 0.131]	0.0005*
gamma	angiogenesis	0.069	[0.036, 0.115]	0.0005*
gamma	hypoxia	0.069	[0.045, 0.109]	0.0005*
contrast	angiogenesis	0.069	[0.036, 0.118]	0.0005*
jpeg	proliferation	0.053	[0.038, 0.118]	0.0005*
contrast	immune_activation	0.049	[0.003, 0.110]	0.0062*
contrast	stromal_ecm	0.043	[0.009, 0.095]	0.0005*
stain_shift	proliferation	0.034	[0.028, 0.065]	0.0005*
stain_shift	immune_activation	0.032	[0.025, 0.040]	0.0005*
stain_shift	stromal_ecm	0.029	[0.016, 0.039]	0.0005*
gamma	stromal_ecm	0.013	[0.008, 0.023]	0.0005*
gamma	immune_activation	0.011	[0.001, 0.023]	0.0032*
gamma	proliferation	0.000	[0.000, 0.014]	0.4768

Table S8: UNI: Gene-Program Flip Rate (GPFR) per perturbation/program on COAD, with 95% CI from the 4-slide cluster bootstrap (2000 resamples) and Benjamini-Hochberg FDR-corrected q -value across all 35 tests. * FDR<0.05 AND the CI's lower bound does not round to 0.000 – with only 4 slides to resample, the one-sided bootstrap p -value is quantized (at most $4^4 = 256$ distinct resample outcomes, giving as few as 6–9 distinct p -values across all 35 tests here), so it can reject the boundary null for an interval that still visibly touches zero; requiring both keeps the star consistent with the printed interval.

Perturbation	Program	GPFR	95% CI	FDR q
stain_shift	hypoxia	0.210	[0.157, 0.304]	0.0006*
scanner_color	angiogenesis	0.201	[0.160, 0.244]	0.0006*
jpeg	hypoxia	0.189	[0.134, 0.282]	0.0006*
scanner_color	hypoxia	0.180	[0.142, 0.249]	0.0006*
jpeg	stromal_ecm	0.166	[0.112, 0.226]	0.0006*
jpeg	angiogenesis	0.146	[0.123, 0.165]	0.0006*
jpeg	immune_activation	0.128	[0.085, 0.171]	0.0006*
scanner_color	immune_activation	0.121	[0.076, 0.179]	0.0006*
brightness	hypoxia	0.114	[0.114, 0.139]	0.0006*
stain_shift	angiogenesis	0.098	[0.056, 0.130]	0.0006*
scanner_color	proliferation	0.089	[0.046, 0.252]	0.0006*
scanner_color	stromal_ecm	0.088	[0.048, 0.120]	0.0006*
stain_shift	proliferation	0.087	[0.047, 0.192]	0.0006*
contrast	hypoxia	0.077	[0.042, 0.144]	0.0006*
gamma	angiogenesis	0.061	[0.045, 0.078]	0.0006*
gamma	hypoxia	0.054	[0.037, 0.094]	0.0006*
stain_shift	stromal_ecm	0.053	[0.021, 0.193]	0.0006*
brightness	angiogenesis	0.052	[0.027, 0.071]	0.0006*
stain_shift	immune_activation	0.052	[0.030, 0.069]	0.0006*
jpeg	proliferation	0.048	[0.038, 0.082]	0.0006*
blur	hypoxia	0.047	[0.038, 0.075]	0.0006*
gamma	stromal_ecm	0.041	[0.022, 0.063]	0.0006*
contrast	angiogenesis	0.033	[0.018, 0.047]	0.0006*
blur	angiogenesis	0.031	[0.013, 0.045]	0.0006*
gamma	proliferation	0.022	[0.007, 0.062]	0.0006*
gamma	immune_activation	0.014	[0.002, 0.036]	0.0006*
contrast	stromal_ecm	0.010	[0.002, 0.019]	0.0087*
brightness	immune_activation	0.010	[0.008, 0.019]	0.0006*
brightness	proliferation	0.008	[0.002, 0.053]	0.0090*
contrast	immune_activation	0.008	[0.004, 0.011]	0.0072*
contrast	proliferation	0.007	[0.004, 0.018]	0.0006*
brightness	stromal_ecm	0.006	[0.000, 0.034]	0.0721
blur	immune_activation	0.003	[0.000, 0.004]	0.0667
blur	stromal_ecm	0.003	[0.000, 0.010]	0.1914
blur	proliferation	0.000	[0.000, 0.004]	0.6452